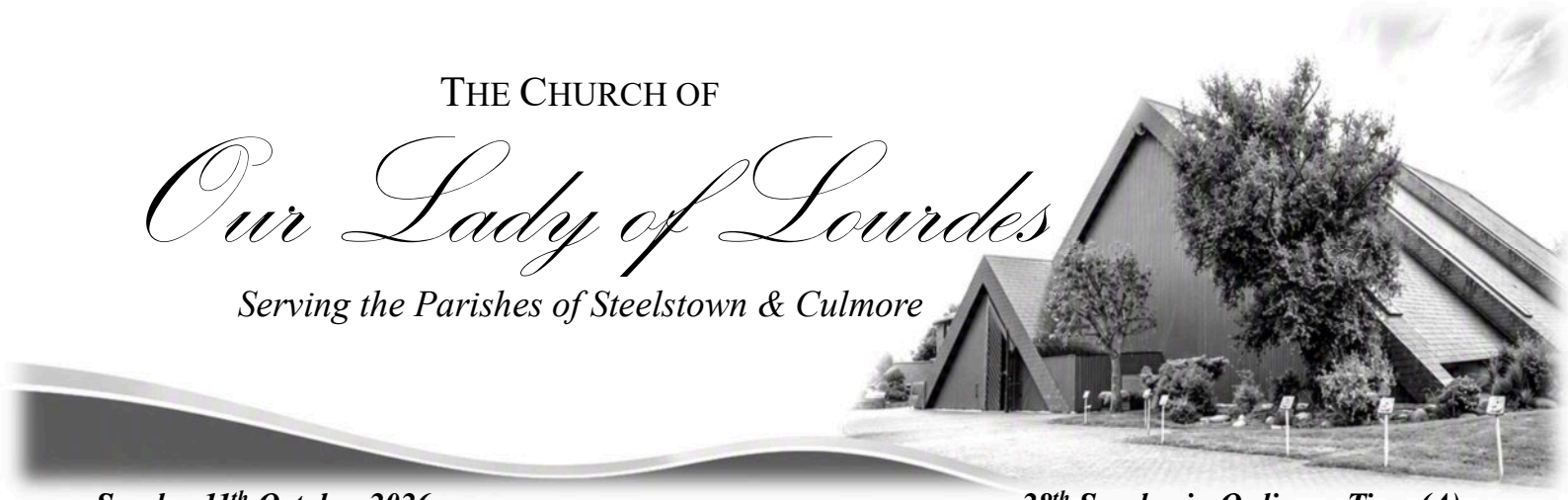
THE CHURCH OF

Our Lady of Lourdes

Serving the Parishes of Steelstown & Culmore



Sunday 11th October 2026 ***28th Sunday in Ordinary Time (A)***

MASS TIMES

SUNDAYS

Vigil: 6.30pm
Sunday: 09.00am;
11.00am;
12.15pm

WEEKDAYS

Monday – Friday: 7.45am
Monday: 7.00pm
Tuesday – Saturday: 10.00am

CONFESSIONS

WEEKEND

Saturday: After 10am Mass;
5.45pm – 6.25pm
Sunday: 10.30am – 10.50am

WEEKDAYS

Monday: 6.30pm – 6.55pm
Tuesday: 8.10am – 8.30am
Thursday: 9.30am – 09.50am

DEVOTIONS

EUCHARISTIC ADORATION

Thursday: 08.00 – 09.55am
10.30am – 12 noon

ROSARY

Before 10am Mass

DIVINE MERCY CHAPLET

After 10am Mass

During his recent visit to the Grotto of Massabielle in Lourdes, Pope Leo XIV made the following appeal. Dear brothers and sisters: I would like to make an appeal that is particularly close to my heart, here in this place. It was here that the Immaculate Virgin appeared to Saint Bernadette with the rosary and, as it were, guided her in prayer. For this reason, today I invite all the faithful and all Christian communities to pray the holy rosary throughout the coming month of October, with the particular intention that wars may cease and that peace may be established among peoples in conflict. Let us accompany this prayer with concrete acts of penance and mercy, committing ourselves always to fostering dialogue and reconciliation. May our most holy Mother intercede for us!"

As we gather here in this church, dedicated to Our Lady of Lourdes, let us take up the Pope's invitation and commit to praying the Holy Rosary each day for peace in our hearts and in our homes, in our country and in our world!

The rosary is recited here on Mondays at 6.30pm and on Tuesdays-Saturdays at 9.30am.

Queen of the Most Holy Rosary, pray for us!

PARISH OFFICE
Wednesday – Friday: 9am – 3pm
028 7135 1718
steelstown@derrydiocese.org / culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST
Rev. Declan McGeehan P.P./Adm.
declan.mcgeehan@derrydiocese.org
Urgent sick calls: 073 5238 7817

SYMPATHY–We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of: John Duffy, 16 Larkhill and Mark Doherty, 77 Drumleck Dr.

ANNIVERSARIES–Please pray for the repose of the souls of: Harry McIvor; Patrick Collins; Margaret Collins; Eugene Grant; Tina Keyes; Chris Allen; John Doherty; Robbie Herron; Annie Doherty; Barney Meenan; Lynn Meenan; Michael Meenan; Mary Sammon; Tommy Sammon and Sarah Patton.

MISSION SUNDAY 18 OCTOBER–Next Sunday is Mission Sunday, a day when we are given the opportunity to express unity and solidarity with Christian communities all over the world. Contributions will be used to build simple mission churches, to educate seminarians as well as female religious novices, to assist in the formation of catechists and lay leaders, for building health facilities for children and adults as well as for providing emergency aid in times of war or natural disaster or to assist missionaries in their efforts to care for refugees. There is an envelope in your box for the Mission Sunday Collection.

PARISH CELLS – Next weekend, after all Masses, you are invited to the Conference Room to learn more about the 'Parish Cell System of Evangelisation'. Parish Cells are small groups of 4 to 12 people who meet in their home every two weeks to deepen their faith and friendship, to encourage one another in living their Christian faith each day, and to explore simple ways of sharing the Gospel with others. For more information, visit: parishcellsireland.ie.

BIBLE ALIVE RENEWAL REMINDER–The Parish order of Bible Alive is due for renewal in November. Bible Alive is a monthly booklet which provides commentary and reflection for the readings used at Mass each day plus articles relating to scripture, prayer and life. If you wish to order Bible Alive for the next year, please contact the Sacristan. Cost is £30 per year or £3 per month. If paying by cheque, please make payable to: 'Our Lady of Lourdes Church'.

DONATIONS-Fr McGeehan acknowledges a donation of £40 for those in need and also donations for the Holy Family Parish in Gaza.

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS – are a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our October event will be a Holy Hour and meditation next Thursday 15th October, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend!

THE EUCHARISTIC MIRACLES OF THE WORLD-Come and discover the remarkable stories of Eucharistic miracles from around the world, brought together through the inspiring work of St Carlo Acutis. This exhibition offers an opportunity for prayer, reflection and a deepening faith. Running until 16 October in St Eugene's Cathedral Hall, Infirmary Road, Derry. Admission is free, all welcome.

RISE & SHINE TRUST–Group 110 (Derry) Do you know a young person who would benefit from a week of friendship, fun, faith and unforgettable memories in Lourdes? Rise & Shine Trust brings children (11+) and young adults with additional needs on a week-long pilgrimage holiday to Lourdes each Easter. The trip is free for our guests as our volunteers fundraise for it. For more information, and to apply, please see www.riseandshine.ie. Applications for the 2027 Easter Pilgrimage are currently open and close on 15 October 2026.

PRAY FOR THE NATIONAL GATHERING OF THE CHURCH IN IRELAND–Bishops, priests, religious and lay people from across Ireland will gather for the National Synodal Assembly on Saturday, 17 October, to pray, listen and discern what God may be asking of the Catholic Church in Ireland at this time. Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part in your prayers. Find out more on: https://derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly.

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR OCTOBER – For mental health ministry Let us pray that mental health ministry be established throughout the Church, helping to overcome the stigma and discrimination of persons with mental illnesses.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE – We are committed to ensuring the safety and well-being of everyone in our parishes. If you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or adults in need of protection within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person, on 07596 500793; or email: marie.okane@derrydiocese.org

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 18th October 2026

Twenty-Ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time

World Mission Sunday - 18th October 2026

This weekend the Church celebrates World Mission Sunday, the weekend when the Pope annually invites all Catholics throughout the world to support the Churches missionary life.

World Mission Sunday is the day set aside by the Catholic Church throughout the world to publicly renew its commitment to its universal mission, it's calling to bring the Good News of Christ to the ends of the earth.

In his message marking the 100th World Mission Sunday Pope Leo reminded us that the unity of the Church as a community of Christ's disciples is inseparable from its missionary outreach to the world: ***'The unity of disciples is not an end in itself; it is directed towards mission. It is through the witness of a reconciled, fraternal and united community that the proclamation of the Gospel acquires its full communicative power.'***

As Christ's disciples, we are all called and sent to be instruments of his compassion in the context of our broken, confused and anxiety riven world.

While all baptised members of the Church are called to bear witness to Christ and the Gospel of love, wherever they are, there is also, within the Church, a special calling to mission outside one's own cultural or national setting – mission ad gentes. Down through the centuries the Church's mission to the nations was carried out by the members of missionary congregations and societies, ready and willing to embark upon a courageous outreach to peoples and cultures outside their homelands.

Irish missionaries and their supporters have made, and continue to make, an outstanding contribution to this missionary outreach. Without the inspiration and leadership given by these women and men, the missionary impulse of the Church would have gradually diminished and died out, and the Church would have never realised its essential vocation to bring the Good News to the ends of the earth.

New Diocesan appointments – Towards the end of last week Bishop Michael Router announced new Diocesan appointments. Fr Patrick Lagan who has served as curate here for the past 4 years is to become the new Parish Priest of both Greencastle and Gortin in Co Tyrone. He is replaced here by Fr Stephen Baxter who was ordained here in Waterside on 14th June this year. Fr Lagan takes up his new appointment on 30th October.

Baptisms – We welcome into God's family: **Kiara Kathleen Gillespie**, The Old Fort

Anniversaries – For those whose anniversaries occur around this time Tina Keyes (nee Herron), Peter O'Donnell, Sarah McGee, Susan McCauley, Noel Patrick McGinley, Lily and Barry McCallion, Jim Irvine, Helen Magee, Grainne Sheils, Patrick O'Donnell, Noreen O'Kane, Evelyn Friel, Eddie McLaughlin, Maureen Phillips, Jackie McLaughlin, Jean Feeny.

Offertory Collections: **Glendermott: £4175 Strathfoyle: £525**
Second Collection this weekend is the Annual Mission Collection
Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible Many of us want to read the Bible but can find it difficult to understand. The Parish will be running 'Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible', an eight-part course that will help us to understand the main story of the Bible and how all the different parts fit together. It gives the 'big picture' and helps us see what the Bible is really about. We will meet on Monday evenings starting on 2nd November at 8pm (after 7.30pm Mass) in the Parish Hall, St Columb's Church. Sessions will begin with prayer, followed by a video presentation and small group discussion. By the end, you'll feel more confident reading the Bible and have a better understanding of how you fit into God's plan. To register for the course, please leave your name and contact details at the Parish Office (028 71 342303 or email secretary@watersideparish.net).

Congratulation to **Chapel Road PS** on being awarded Primary School of the Year – County Derry at the Local Women Education Awards 2026. Also, the Building Supervisor Derek McCallion was awarded Best Support Staff.

Trench Road Folk Group have returned for practises on Wednesday evenings in Malvern Terrace Parish Hall at 7pm. New and returning singers are welcome. Ages P7 up to and including adults.

He who sings, prays twice." (St Augustine) – St Columb's Church resumed in September. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Markus or any choir members

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community: Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7:30pm, starting ***20 October***, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Centring Prayer Group – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb's Church (Parish Hall)

Rosary on the Beach – The Holy Rosary will be prayed on Sunday 18th October at 3:00pm at Lisfannon Beach.

Struggling to understand how Direct Payments work? Looking for more information on how they could support you or someone you care for?
Join us for a free information session delivered by The Centre for Independent Living, where you'll learn more about Direct Payments, how to access them, and the benefits they can provide on 22nd October at 12 noon.
Venue: Health for Life HLC, Central Drive, Creggan, BT48 9QG
To book your place or find out more, contact Eilish Brown at eilish.brown@healthforlifenw.org

Prayer for the Missionaries

Lord our God, loving Father,
We humbly pray to you for our beloved missionaries, heralds of the Gospel,

May our Prayers reach their hearts that they may feel our love, our strength, our faith.

May our prayers reach their hearts that they continue with your zeal the mission you entrust them with.

May their presence in their community be a reminder of your presence among us.
Amen.

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	**10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm**
Church of Immaculate Conception	**10.15am & 12.15pm**
St Oliver Plunkett Church	**11.15am**
St Mary's Oratory	**9.15am**

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	**10.00am & 7.30pm**
Church of Immaculate Conception	**9.15am**
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	**11.00am Mon. Tues. Thurs.**
St Mary's Oratory	**11.00am – Wednesday only**

Saturday

St Columb's Church	**10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)**
Church of Immaculate Conception	**6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)**
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	**6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)**

Confessions

St Columb's Church	**Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm**
	Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	**Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm**
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	**Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm**

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303
Email: secretary@watersideparish.net Web: www.watersideparish.net
YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

Rev. Michael Canny PP 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net
Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersidepaish.net
Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.